



REPURPOSING OLD TECH

Give new life to forgotten tech

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These days we change and upgrade our tech almost as frequently as we change our wardrobe and give ourselves a makeover. While it may give us a shiny new device to use, enjoy and show off, the inadvertent side effect is a ton of slightly old tech that fills our junk drawer or the landfills. Oh, and it is also quite the drain on your wallet, which in the best of times is a bad idea financially and in times of recession, is something that needs to be curbed as much as possible. So in the next two pages or so we will try our darndest to at the very least make the best use of the pile of old consumer tech you have lying

around so that you don't go out and buy something that you don't need.

PHONES

Let's get the most bought consumer device out of the way first since we all pretty much would have a couple of older smartphones lying around and in need of some purpose. Most of the time these spare phones still have a ton of life left in them, but the



newer shiner models on the market make them feel like they are past their prime. The most common problem people seem to have with their older devices though is the battery life that has deteriorated over time either naturally, or through some software trickery pushed by the manufacturer to make it less usable. The obvious answer is to use the device for purposes where it can stay plugged in most of the time. One of the most useful scenarios is to use it in your car as a navigation and media device. And if you are up for some tinkering you can even use it as a dashcam which can upload video directly to your preferred cloud service.

Really old smartphones which have nowhere close to the processing grunt required for modern apps can be used as cool bedside clocks and even as remotes to control various devices in your home like TVs, ACs and other smart products. The trick with using really old smartphones is to just use a couple of apps on them and not overload them too much.

There are a ton of possibilities with more recent smartphones though. One of our favourites is to use it as a retro gaming console. Smartphones of the last 5 years are quite powerful computing devices. Even more powerful than dedicated gaming consoles of old, like the PSP, PS Vita, the entire collection of Game-Boy's and a few other consoles that were big parts of our childhood. So in case you are feeling a bit nostalgic or just want to experience some of the awesome games that you never got the chance to play because you didn't have the console, a relatively modern smartphone is your ticket to it.

TABLETS

Another gadget that suffers a similar fate to smartphones due to the launches of newer models is tablets. They too slow down after a while and have similar battery deterioration issues just like smartphones. But tablets can be saved from the depths of the junk drawer as well and be put to good use. For example, tablets are the perfect device to read on due to their size and can be made into your